Plain line for reference

plain text line

Inline-block 40px high in a span (baseline at the bottom margin edge of an empty box)

text text

Inline-block with text: baseline is that of its last line

one
two
text three text

Three levels with different font-size and line-height (grandchild decides the line)

small medium large

A shorter child inside a tall parent line-height: the parent's strut keeps the line tall

parent child

Child raised by vertical-align: 20px extends the line upward

text text

Child lowered by vertical-align: -20px extends the line downward

text text

Inline-block with vertical-align: middle in a span with larger font

lowered

text text